

Ancient History





About the Course

Study history stories about the ancient civilizations that lived from 100 BC to 350 AD. View images and reference atlases and maps to set the people and events in their time and place. Update History Charts and Book of Centuries as appropriate for student level.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grades 5-6 (U.S.), History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
5-6	Ancient History: Grades 5-6 1 time/week 25 min	The Bronze Bow Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grades 5-6 (U.S.)				
	U.S. History: Grades 4-6		World History: Grades 4-6	Ancient History: Grades 5-6
History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)				
	Canadian History: Grades 5-6		World History: Grades 4-6	Ancient History: Grades 5-6



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)

☐ Read the document in the Quick Links about History Timelines and Charts.

☐ We encourage you to pick a biography for each term to read in the afternoons. The Bookshelf has many recommendations.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Ancient History: Grades 5-6



The Bronze Bow



Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.](#)



Ancient History: Grades 5-6

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.

- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 1

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 2 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 2

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 3 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 3

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

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Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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Term 1

WEEK 4 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 4

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 5 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 5

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 6 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 6

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

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Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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Term 1

WEEK 7 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 7

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 8 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 8

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 9 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 9

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

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Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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Term 1

WEEK 10 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 10

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 11 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 11

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 12 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 12

→ EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE. QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: BRONZE BOW

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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Term 2

WEEK 1 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 13

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 2 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 14

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 3 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 15

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

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Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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Term 2

WEEK 4 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 16

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 5 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 17

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 6 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 18

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

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Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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Term 2

WEEK 7 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 19

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 8 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 20

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

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WEEK 9 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 21

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

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Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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Term 2

WEEK 10 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 22

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 11 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 23

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 12 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 24

→ EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE. QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: BRONZE BOW

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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Term 3

WEEK 1 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 25

The Ancient Church; Peter

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

In the Bronze Bow, you read a historical fiction book about what was happening in the land of Israel during the time of Jesus around 30 AD. This book tells true accounts of the Christians who lived in the 1st century and carried on the message of Jesus after he ascended into heaven. The events in this book take place from 30 AD to 350 AD. This was still a time when the Romans controlled all the areas around the Mediterranean Sea. All the people you will meet lived in Roman occupied territories. Let's first look at a map to understand what the Roman Empire looked like at this time.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World p.16-17

- 1.Name all the bodies of water that surround the Roman Empire, (Atlantic Ocean, Cantabrian Sea, North Sea, Mediterranean Sea, Ligurian Sea, Tyrrhenian Sea, Adriatic Sea, Ionian Sea, Aegean Sea, Adriatic Sea, Black Sea, Red Sea)
- 2.What country was furthest north in the Roman Empire? (Britain)
- 3.What walls were built near the northernmost part of the Roman Empire? (Wall of Hadrian and Wall of Antoninus)
- 4.What country was furthest south in the Roman Republic? (Egypt)
- 5.What country was furthest west in the Roman Republic? (Spain)
- 6.What country was furthest east in the Roman Republic? (Osroene)
- 7.What two rivers in the north formed the borders between the Roman Empire and Germany? (Rhine and Danube)
- 8.Find Jerusalem. That is where the apostles were after the ascension of Jesus.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.p.11-12 "At not point" - "was increasingly marginalized." Then last paragraph on p. 13 "The story of.."

2.We will read about the apostle Peter. What do you remember about him? (He cut off the ear of a soldier when Jesus was arrested in the Garden of Gethsemane, he denied Jesus three times) The event we will read about is told in the Bible in Acts 2. Forty days after the resurrection and tens days after Jesus ascended to heaven, about 120 followers of Christ gathered together in Jerusalem to celebrate a Jewish feast that had been celebrated since the Old Testament.
p. 17-21 "Peter took the" - "And prayed."

• DEFINITIONS

frayed: fragile or uncertain (p.11)

ambassador: representative or messenger (p.11)

marginalized: given an unimportant or powerless position within a society or group (p.12)

zealot: member of a first-century Jewish political movement that fiercely opposed the Roman occupation of Judea (p.20)

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 2 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 26

Peter; begin Paul

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

You are reading parts of two chapters today. You will finish the chapter about Peter and find out what happened on the special event we call "The Church's Birthday." Then you will start the section on Paul who was not one of the original twelve apostles of Jesus but was used mightily by God to spread the gospel message.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.p.21- 25 "Peter did not know"-end

- Why is this event know as the church's birthday?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Pentecost by Giotto

Many artists have painted scenes of the Holy Spirit coming at Pentecost. Take a moment to look at this painting from Giotto painted around 1310-18. What is the centerpiece of the painting? (dove) What do you notice around the heads of the apostles? Artists traditionally put halos or a glowing rings of light to show a holy or sacred figure. You also notice the "tongues of fire." Do you see the two men outside of the doors? Giotto painted the scene using a low wall to divide those experiencing the event and those straining to hear what was going on.

2.Now we meet the apostle Paul whose story is also told in the Bible. He wrote 13 of the 27 books of the New Testament. His writings were initially letters or epistles written to various churches. The story we are reading today can be found in Acts 16.

p.29-31 "This way!" - "but little comfort."

• DEFINITIONS

gale: a strong current of air (p.21)

Shavuot: Jewish holiday (p.23)

lunacy: insanity, madness (p.29)

orator: (p.29)

WEEK 3 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 27

Paul

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times, The Student Bible Atlas

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Map in the book on p.33 or Student Bible Atlas p.20-21

Find Philippi. What country is that part of? (Macedonia) Paul had traveled there on his missionary journeys.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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p.32-38

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: This video from the Bible Project tells more about the life of Paul and his missionary journeys.

WEEK 4 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 28

Persecution of the Church

📄 Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times

NOTE: We are skipping Fact Files p.39-42 and reading this PDF instead.

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

You will read a chapter about why the Romans despised the Christians and how that led to persecution and the killing of Christians.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ PDF Link: Trial by Fire (from The Church of Our Fathers by Roland Bainton)

Skip the section about Polycarp p.23-24 "There was a" - "through Jesus Christ."

- What made Christianity so different than the religions of Rome?
- Why do you think so many Christians were willing to die for their faith?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview p.22-23 that talk about Nero's treatment of Christians and the accusation that Christians were cannibals. It may not be appropriate for sensitive students.

WEEK 5 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 29

Ignatius

📄 Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times, The Student Bible Atlas

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

📄 Map Resource: Student Bible Atlas p.20-21

Find Antioch on the east side of the Mediterranean Sea. Why do you think that location would be a good place for trade and the spread of Christianity? Antioch was one of the largest cities in the first-century Roman world, accommodating a population between 100,000 and 300,000. There was a thriving church there made up of Jews and Gentiles and Paul had stayed there for a whole year ministering to the people. (Acts 11) Trace a sea route to Rome that stays close to the coast.

→ INTRO

We will read about Ignatius who was bishop of Antioch (modern-day Turkey) for forty years, probably from AD 67–106. At this time, it was the policy of the Roman government to not to seek out Christians, but still to punish them when they were brought before the authorities. "Once accused and brought before

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Term 3

the authorities, Christians had to be forced to worship the gods of the empire, or face punishment...Since great festivities were being planned in Rome in celebration of a military victory, Ignatius was sent to the capital so that his death might provide entertainment for the people. On his way to martyrdom, he wrote seven letters that are among the most valuable documents informing our knowledge of early Christianity" (Justo Gonzalez, The Story of Christianity).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.45-51

- Why do you think he had such courage to face his death?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Links:

- 1.Fresco of Ignatius of Antioch
- 2.Inside view of the Colosseum where many Christian were martyred.

WEEK 6 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 30

Polycarp

📖 Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

📖 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World p.16-17

Find Smyrna (E5) Where is it located? (In Asia Minor on the coast of the Aegean Sea.

→ INTRO

We will read about another bishop and martyr of the second century. His name was Polycarp which means 'much fruit' in Greek. Many years earlier than when this account takes place, Ignatius of Antioch had advised young Bishop Polycarp regarding his duties as bishop and the need to be firm in his faith. You may remember that Ignatius wrote 7 letters on his way to Rome. One of those letters was to Polycarp. We will read how Polycarp showed himself a worthy recipient of Ignatius's advice, and a follower of his example.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.53-60

- Did you notice what the Romans called Polycarp? (Roman persecutors called the Christians "atheists" because they refused to worship the Roman gods.)Why is that odd to call him that?
- What do you think about Polycarp's last speech? What does it tell us about his faith?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Fresco of Polycarp

• DEFINITIONS

dotard: a person exhibiting mental decline especially in old age (p.58)



Term 3

WEEK 7 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 31

Cyprian

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World p.16-17

Find Carthage (F7) Where is it located? (In Africa on the Mediterranean Sea.)

→ INTRO

Cyprian was the bishop of the church in Carthage from 248 to 258 AD. His writings and teachers have been beneficial to Christians. He helped Christians navigate the question: Do we let people who denied Christ under the threat of torture and death back into the church if they repent?

→ BACKGROUND

In AD 250 the most violent persecution the church had yet faced was instigated by the emperor Decius (249–51). Decius was determined to have no nonsense from Christians. In his eyes, they were enemies of the empire. Their atheism was responsible for the many troubles in the realm. Thus Decius commanded all citizens of the empire to sacrifice to the traditional Roman gods. Those who did so were given certificates (libelli in Latin) as evidence that they had obeyed the order. Those who refused to comply and were unable (or unwilling) to obtain false libelli from sympathetic or corrupt officials faced death. To save their lives, many Christians complied. Others were able to obtain certificates without having actually sacrificed. But an unknown number of Christians were imprisoned or executed—among them the bishops of Rome, Antioch, and Jerusalem. (Church History in Plain Language)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.63-71

- How important is it for Christians to be part of a church body and to attend church regularly? What do you think Cyprian was saying about that topic?
- Why do you think there was disagreement on whether those who denied their faith should be let back in the church?

→ VIEW

This is a mosaic that is on the wall in a church in Ravenna, Italy that was constructed in the 6th century. A mosaic is a pattern or image made of small regular or irregular pieces of colored stone or glass held in place by plaster and covering a surface. Mosaics are often used as floor and wall decoration, and were particularly popular in the ancient Roman world. On this wall is a procession of martyrs walking from the king's palace towards Christ's throne in heaven. In the other image you can see the inside of the church. Polycarp was also represented in this mosaic.

∞ Image Links: Mosaic of Cyprian, Inside of

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Term 3

WEEK 8 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 32

Cyprian/Fact Files

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.72-76

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 9 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 33

Constantine

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Throughout its first three centuries, the church went through unimaginable persecution from the Roman Empire, though all the time growing and spreading. So imagine what an extraordinary turn of events it was when the Roman Emperor himself became a Christian. We will read about that

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.79-88

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 10 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 34

Finish Constantine/Athanasius

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times

→RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.91-99

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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Term 3	
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WEEK 11 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 35 Finish Athanasius Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times → RECAP What did you read last time? → INTRO Information → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.100-103 → PROMPT ∞ Image Link: Title of Image	
WEEK 12 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 36 → EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE. QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: REDEMPTION: THE CHURCH IN ANCIENT TIMES	